

Architect | Technologist | Innovation Specialist

Adam Raman

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Nationality: Malaysian

Location: Sendai, Japan (Open to Relocation / Hybrid / Remote)

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Ex-Founder | Advocate for Human-Centric Design & Process Automation

Professional Summary

Innovation Strategist, Architect, and former founder with 10+ years of experience running a design-and-build firm. Helped redefine the local construction industry through BIM utilization and contractual cost optimization. Followed by research sabbatical in energy tech and climate-conscious building science at Tohoku University, I now build digital tools and AI workflows that bridge the gap between complex engineering systems and day to day operations.

Core Skills & Expertise

Design & Spatial Planning: Architectural Design, Place making, Human-Centric Design, 3D/BIM Modeling, CAD, Building and material science.

Business & Leadership: Project Management, Business Development, Budgeting & P&L, Market trend forecasting, Team Leadership, Client Relations, Design Thinking.

Smart Workflows & AI: AI workflows, Custom Digital Tools, Process Automation, Smart Home Systems (IoT), Data driven decision making.

Sustainable Building Science: Climate Tech, Building Energy Evaluation, Passive Cooling/Dehumidification, Renewable Energy Systems, Eco-Friendly Architecture.

Professional Experience

1) *Building Energy Architect* | Refil 合同会社 Japan | 2025 – 2026 - ongoing

Energy Systems Design:

Conducted building energy audits and designed mechanical HVAC systems for new builds to optimize for sustainability and comfort.

Process Automation:

Built internal digital tools to benchmark Japanese Industrial Standards (JIS) and regulatory compliance. Designed and implemented AI-driven RAG workflows to automate routine documentation, boosting team cross-project data consistency.

2) *Founder, Managing Director & Design Lead | Lakar Design Malaysia | 2012 – 2022 - 10 years*

Business Growth:

Bootstrapped and scaled a design-build firm to 8 consecutive years of profitability, driving 100% YoY revenue growth via a user-first, word-of-mouth pipeline.

Market Disruption:

Pioneered an affordable designer renovation model in Malaysia, lowering project costs by 20–30% through innovative contract formats without compromising aesthetic quality.

P&L Management:

Maintained full P&L responsibility for residential and commercial construction projects, managing project margins and company cashflows. Conducted resource assessment and allocation to ensure optimal utilization of personnel, equipment, and time across concurrent design and construction projects.

Tech Integration:

Partnered with local suppliers to integrate cutting-edge construction tech such as lightweight fireproof structures, and smart home IoT systems.

Team Management

Facilitated clear communication, aligning expectations, and ensuring timely decision-making among clients, suppliers, multi-disciplinary consultant and subcontractor teams.

3) *Assistant Lecturer & Facilitator | MARA University of Technology (UiTM) Malaysia | 2016 – 2019 - 3 years*

Curriculum Delivery :

Developed and taught academic modules focusing on Design Thinking and Human Sensibility.

Mentorship:

Mentored over 200 students in applying human-centric design methodologies to real-world spatial problems.

4) *Architect | S&A Architects Malaysia | 2009 – 2011 - 2 years*

Award-Winning Design:

Acted as Lead Designer for a low-rise housing development that won the prestigious PAM Award 2017 (Multiple Residential Low-Rise).

Project Turnaround:

Successfully revived an abandoned 17-story high-rise housing project, scaling the firm's role from interior designer to lead architect through diligent project management.

Education

- **PhD (Climate Tech R&D) – Tohoku University, Japan (2025)**

Thesis: Engineered a solar-regenerated passive desiccant hardware solution, achieving up to 50% reduction in cooling energy loads for hot/humid climate nights.

Transformed multi-source raw environmental data into interoperable formats for AI-assisted simulation workflows.

- **Master of Architecture (ARB Part 2) – University of Manchester, UK (2011)**

(Japan equivalent to Second Class Architect qualification)

Dissertation: Barriers to Energy Efficiency in Existing Housing Stock.

Thesis: Continuity in Architecture – Research on adaptive reuse of historical buildings.

Thesis: Prototype 01 – Experimentation on construction materials and digital manufacturing methodologies.

- **Bachelor of Science in Architecture (ARB Part 1) – UiTM, Malaysia (2008)**

Honors: Dean's Award. Graduated Top of Class. Silver medalist at Inventions and Innovations UiTM 2006.

Languages & Certifications

- Languages: English (C2), Malay (C2), Japanese (JLPT N3/N2 business equivalent).
- Certifications: IELTS Band 8.0 (2021) | RIBA Architect Accredited | LAM Accredited.
- License: Japanese and Malaysian Driving licenses. Malaysia Construction license

Other Experience

- **Teaching Assistant | Tohoku University, Sendai (2023 – 2025):** Thought English as a second language to Japanese University students.
- **Cultural Educator | MIA/SenTIA, Sendai (2023 – 2025):** Delivered formal presentations and workshops for academic and public audiences, effectively translating technical design and innovation concepts into accessible, compelling narratives.
- **International Sourcing Specialist | Awatar Ltd, UK (2023 – 2025):** Sourcing and global logistics for vinyl records (USA, UK, France).

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- **Concert Organizer | KNUKE, Manchester (2010):** Organized concert tours for Malaysian bands in the UK, managing venues, logistics, and partnerships.
- **Music Band | (2001-2020):** Performed as a band member in weddings and events.